

vacations a year, a paid-off car, affordable housing, excellent medical coverage, fully funded retirement accounts, top-shelf skin-care products, and if we're really shooting for the moon, let's throw in a pool!

For Jack, his curiosity about what's hiding under damp logs led him to want more and more of that thing. And this is the propensity for us all. When you first think about buying what you love without going broke, you may be thinking, there are a lot of things I love, and I want to know how to afford them all! It's where we all start. You want to love everything and be able to say yes to all of it, and when you can't, you think it's a money problem or a "you" problem.

Unfortunately, Jack couldn't have all the slugs hiding in the woods that day, and I still don't have great medical coverage or a pool. But I learned something from his adorable (and slightly gross) approach to discovering the world around him. He was genuinely curious about these slimy creatures, and while his version of curiosity led to extreme slug hoarding, our version can help us refine our list of what we love. We often try to find what we value by getting curious about the things we can buy, but truly finding what you value actually comes from getting curious about yourself.

Practicing curiosity comes quite naturally to kids because they have so much to discover about themselves, the people they love, and the greater world around them. We can lose sight of this ability by adulthood and forget to approach our circumstances with this posture. We think we've got a pretty good grasp on knowing ourselves, only to find that the things we "know" are a combination of things we've picked up or been influenced by along the way, and some of it may not actually fit us.

But what would it look like if we made efforts to take on a "not-knowing" posture? I'm not talking about playing dumb, but rather actively rejecting assumptions. This would also mean approaching our various circumstances without pretending to know the future, what's going to happen next, or thinking that we know the meaning of each occurrence, decision, or behavior—of others or ourselves!

If I've learned anything from my nieces and nephews, it's that curiosity is aimed at discovery and not assuming what might be found. Curiosity comes with more questions than answers and includes exploration. Sometimes curiosity is satisfied and sometimes it leads to more curiosity. But the best version of curiosity is the kind that doesn't already know the answers, isn't